# LEAVE POLICY PLAN

Professional Draft Template | India-focused workplace policy

**Organization:** [Organization Name]

**Effective date:** [Insert Effective Date]

**Status:** Draft for review

## Purpose of this document

This editable template provides a structured starting point for an employee leave policy. Customize bracketed fields and validate legal requirements before adoption.

## 1. Purpose

• This policy establishes a clear and consistent process for requesting, approving, recording, and managing employee leave. It is intended to support employee well-being while maintaining business continuity.

## 2. Scope

• This draft applies to employees of [Organization Name]. The organization should define whether it covers permanent, probationary, fixed-term, part-time, contract, and intern roles. Applicable employment laws, state rules, standing orders, and employment contracts take precedence over this template.

## 3. Policy principles

• Leave should be planned in advance wherever practical.

• Unexpected illness or emergencies should be reported as soon as reasonably possible.

• Approval depends on leave balance, applicable rules, staffing needs, and the designated approver.

• Leave records must be accurate, confidential, and maintained by HR or the authorized team.

• Managers should apply the policy consistently and without discrimination.

## 4. Leave categories — proposed planning framework

• Casual Leave (CL): For personal matters and short-duration needs. Suggested planning allowance: 6 days per calendar year.

• Sick Leave (SL): For illness, injury, medical appointments, or recovery. Suggested planning allowance: 6 days per calendar year. A medical certificate may be requested for extended or repeated absence, subject to applicable law and privacy requirements.

• Earned / Privilege Leave (EL/PL): For planned holidays and longer breaks. Suggested planning allowance: 15 days per calendar year, accrued monthly where the organization chooses to use an accrual model.

• Public / Festival Holidays: Published separately in the annual holiday calendar, according to applicable rules and business requirements.

• Unpaid Leave (LWP): May be considered when paid leave is exhausted or unavailable, subject to approval and applicable law.

• Parental, maternity, paternity, adoption, bereavement, and other statutory or special leave: Administered in accordance with applicable law and the organization's approved benefits.

## 5. Important note on leave entitlements

• The numbers above are illustrative planning assumptions only, not a statement of legal minimums. Before adoption, HR/legal should confirm the required leave types, minimum entitlements, accrual, carry-forward, encashment, eligibility, and holiday rules for each work location and employee category.

## 6. Request and approval process

• Planned leave: Submit a request through the approved HR system or form, preferably at least 3 working days in advance for 1–2 days and 2 weeks in advance for longer leave.

• Emergency or sick leave: Notify the manager as soon as possible by the approved channel; submit the formal record when reasonably practicable.

• Approval: The reporting manager reviews work coverage and leave balance. HR reviews exceptions, statutory leave, and policy questions.

• Confirmation: Employees should wait for approval before making non-refundable plans, except where an emergency or applicable law requires otherwise.

• Return to work: Employees should update their status and complete any required attendance or documentation steps.

## 7. Roles and responsibilities

• Employee: Give timely notice, provide required documentation where lawful, hand over urgent work, and check approval status.

• Manager: Review requests fairly, plan coverage, communicate decisions promptly, and avoid unnecessary disclosure of medical or personal details.

• HR / People Operations: Maintain records, explain entitlements, handle exceptions, monitor consistency, and review the policy periodically.

• Payroll: Apply approved leave and unpaid leave entries correctly to payroll.

## 8. Carry-forward, lapse, and encashment

• Define the maximum carry-forward balance, expiry rules, and whether unused earned leave can be encashed. These rules must be confirmed against applicable law and employment terms before launch.

• Suggested draft placeholder: Earned leave carry-forward cap = [Insert Number] days; encashment = [Allowed / Not Allowed / As Required by Law]. Casual and sick leave treatment = [Insert Rule].

## 9. Extended absence and return-to-work

• For extended absence, the employee should maintain reasonable contact with the manager or HR. HR should handle supporting documents confidentially and coordinate reasonable return-to-work arrangements where appropriate.

## 10. Misuse, exceptions, and disputes

• Falsification of leave records or repeated failure to follow notification procedures may be handled under the organization's disciplinary process, consistent with applicable law.

• Exceptions should be documented and approved by HR or the designated authority. Employees may raise questions or concerns with HR without retaliation.

## 11. Records and privacy

• Access to leave records should be limited to people who need the information for HR, management, compliance, or payroll purposes. Medical details should be collected only when necessary and handled confidentially.

## 12. Review and governance

• Policy owner: HR / People Operations.

• Approver: [Authorized Approver / Leadership Team].

• Review frequency: Annually, and whenever applicable law or organizational requirements change.

• Version: 1.0 | Status: Draft for review.

## Appendix A — Proposed Leave Summary

| Leave Type | Suggested Annual Allowance | Typical Use | Approval / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Casual Leave (CL) | 6 days (illustrative) | Personal needs; short absences | Advance notice where possible |
| Sick Leave (SL) | 6 days (illustrative) | Illness, injury, recovery | Notify promptly; documents only where lawful/needed |
| Earned / Privilege Leave (EL/PL) | 15 days (illustrative) | Planned holidays / longer breaks | Consider accrual and carry-forward rules |
| Public / Festival Holidays | As per annual calendar | Declared holidays | Confirm applicable rules and work location |
| Unpaid Leave (LWP) | As approved | When paid leave is unavailable | May affect pay; HR/payroll review |
| Statutory / Special Leave | As required by law / approved policy | Maternity, parental, bereavement, etc. | HR to confirm eligibility and legal requirements |

**Disclaimer:** This is a general template and is not legal advice. Suggested leave quantities are illustrative and must be reviewed against current applicable laws and local employment requirements before implementation.